TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
REGULAR MONTHLY MEETING
WEDNESDAY, AUGUST 11 , 2021
6:30 PM
REVISED

1. **Call to order**

   Mayor Goette called the regularly scheduled meeting at 6:32 pm.

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**

   Those present were Mayor Beth Goette and Council Members: Dana Williams, Dave Crenshaw, Larry Ward, Ed Drohan, John Henry and Brooks Barbaree. Staff in attendance: Town Administrator, Bob Milie; Finance Administrator, Shelly Jameson; Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow; Clerk of Council, Deatre Denion; Public Works Manager, Oscar Crosby; Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman and Police Chief, Sean Clayton.

3. **Approval of Meeting Agenda**

   Mayor Goette stated there is an addition to the agenda. Item 7. Event Permit and Waiver for Sons of the American Legion Squadron 500 for September 25, 2021. Mayor Goette asked for a motion for the amended agenda. **Council Member Williams made the motion with a second from Council Member Ward. The motion passes unanimously.**

4. **Approval of Minutes from Previous Meeting**:
   Minutes of July 14, 2021, Water Conservation Workshop and Special Called Meeting on July 28, 2021

   Mayor Goette asked for a motion to approve the regular July 14th meeting, Water Conservation Workshop and Special Called meeting on July 28th. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve the meeting minutes with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

5. **Kid City USA Presentation**

   Danny McIntosh, 21 Century and Linda Morrison, Kid City USA; came forth an explained Kid City USA is a day care franchise out of Point Orange FL. They cater to infants and children up to 12 years of age. At this location they would only cater to infants and children up to 4 years of age. All staff is trained and licensed. There is a curriculum that is followed. Kid City USA has 75 locations in 7 states. This location can accommodate up to 90 children, but Ms. Morrison stated she would rather accommodate fewer children. The license rule is 35 sq ft per child. Council Member Henry asked about the age limit. Ms. Morrison explained the limit was due to playground space per child. The permitted number is 1 adult to 6 infants, Ms. Morrison stated they will have 1 adult to 4 infants. Council Member Drohan asked the maximum number of children will be accepted. Ms. Morrison stated between 65 to 70 and there will be an equally distribution across ages. Council Member Williams asked about parking and traffic. He told Ms. Morrison she is looking at 40 to 50 cars coming in to drop off. The Fire Department is next door and Fire Trucks will need to get out. Ms. Morrison stated she understands the concern.

She explained the road on right would be the entrance access. The parking is on left and more than she needs. Council Member Williams also asked about playground and concrete. Ms. Morrison explained there would not be any removal of the concrete. Mayor Goette asked about number of staff. Ms. Morrison explained there would be a Director, Assistant Director and max of 10 to 12 staff members. Mayor Goette asked about time of operation. Ms. Morrison explained normally it would be 6 am to 6 pm, but she is looking to 7 am to 5:30 pm. Mayor Goette asked about the tree in the front. Ms. Morrison stated she would never remove the tree it would be a part landscape in the playground and used for the science lessons. Mayor Goette asked about fence size requirements Ms. Morrison stated she would like to put up a very nice vinyl. Mayor Goette asked about parking. The staff would take up most of the parking space. Ms. Morrison stated the staff typically ride share or take the bus. Other option is to talk with a partner about leasing parking. Council Member Williams asked about length of lease. Wanted to know if this was a sticking point. Ms. Morrison stated it was not. The Stephenson location has a10 years lease. Mayor Goette spoke of concern about zoning. Town Administrator Milie spoke on what is allowed in the current zoning. Council Member Crenshaw followed up on the 15 year lease. He asked if she would be willing to do a shorter lease and fewer number of children? Ms. Morrison stated no lease is the same of the 75 locations. Mayor Goette points out location of an alcohol license near the school. Town Administrator Milie points out we are getting further down the road than we need. Town Attorney Barrow is still reviewing the legalities of the zoning and alcohol issues. Council Member Barbaree asked if the school would be Monday to Friday. Ms. Morrison stated yes.

Catherine Clements, 3212 Cedar Street, asked about there being a discount to staff, military, and residents. Town employees would get a discount. She asked about meals at the school. Ms. Morrison explained they would only supply snacks, parents would need to pack the lunch. She went on to explain one reason is the location does not have a proper kitchen that would be needed.

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Christina Johnson, Gragg Street, asked about internship availability. Ms. Morrison explained they school who needs internships would be welcome.

Council Member Crenshaw asked Anna Maria Thomas about the renting parking from the museum. Ms. Thomas explained the board would need to make that decision. Council Member Crenshaw asked how does Council move forward. Town Attorney Barrow stated before Council goes any further, he needs to look into the zoning and alcohol issues. Town Attorney Barrow and Town Administrator Milie are to work out the details.

6. **Home Occupation Application for Masonry Masters LLC at 302 Laurel Oak Lane**

Timothy Bader attended virtually. He explained his home is to where paperwork will be completed, i.e. payroll and printing plans. There will be no equipment on site. There were no questions from Council. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve the home occupation application with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

7. **Event Permit and Waiver for Sons of the American Legion Squadron 500 for September 25, 2021**

Eddie L. Patterson came forward to explain this event is a fundraiser. It is a car and bike show. They will be using the grass in front of the building. There will have an on off duty officer. This event is free to public. Mayor Goette asked number of people and what type of vendors. Mr. Patterson stated a few hundred. He explained they do have sponsors and there will be DJ music. No alcohol will be sold. Council Member **Williams made the motion to approve the application and grant the waiver. Council Member Ward seconded the motion. The motion passed unanimously.**

8. **Approval of Medical Director Memorandum of Understanding**

Town Administrator Milie remind Council this was tabled from the last meeting. Chatham County will cover the cost of having this Medical Director agreement. Town of Attorney stated the only change should be the contract

should be with the Town not Fire Dept. Council Member Crenshaw asked if there is a kill clause. Fire Chief Bateman stated there is. **Council Member Williams made the motion to approve the MOU with a second from Council Member Crenshaw.** Council Member Williams asked Chief Bateman if was ok with the MOU. **The motion passed unanimously.**

9. **Appointment of Pension Secretary for GMA**

Town Administrator Milie stated this is a formality to replace the current Pension Secretary with the new Finance Administrator, Shelly Jameson. **Council Member Crenshaw made the motion to approve Shelly Jameson as the new Pension Secretary with a second by Council Member Williams. The motion passed unanimously.**

10. **Approval of the 2021 Millage Rate**

Mayor Goette stated the Town has had the three required public hearings to hold the millage rate at 6.132. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve the recommended millage rate with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

11. **Town Administrator Report:** Town Administrator, Bob Milie

Town Administrator stated he has been working on T-SPLOST. Initially the County offered a million and Thunderbolt has countered by requesting 4.8 million and now it is down to 2 million. He goes on to state he is chasing some SPLOST 6 funding. HR is currently updating all files, working job description vs actual roles. Finance is working with QS1 to utilize all the functions of the software. Council Member Drohan asked when would Finance Administrator Jameson be able to talk about software. Town Administrator Milie stated it is being worked on and would let all of Council know when all information is gathered. Council Member Crenshaw gave a brief history about switching to QS1 and explained it has never worked as staff wanted. Town Administrator Milie goes on with Code Enforcement working on the trash cans as Council has requested and has looked into a software that will combine information from building permits to violations. Town Administrator Milie is working on the Bonaventure Road concerns. Chief Clayton has pulled speed data for Gilbert Street. He noted Public Works has been working to beautify the front of Town Hall. Town Administrator asked all to wish Chief Bateman a Happy Birthday.

Council Member Crenshaw asked about the meeting with John Sawyer. Town Administrator Milie stated there is lapses in information from the vendor. Mr. Sawyer did state Savannah did replace some sections of the sewer main going to President Street. He also provided some knowledge of the quality of the line.

Council Member Crenshaw asked for the Town Administrator, Code Enforcement and at least one Council Member to meet with the Judges on blighted homes.

Council Member Williams stated he spoke with Walmart and Home Depot to see if they could provide assistance to those on fixed income and need to make repairs. They are willing to assist.

12. **Finance Report**:

a) Municipal Tax Collections in 2021

Tax Years 2011-2020	$ 51,137.98
Tax Year 2021	$ 268,039.90

b) Municipal Tax Outstanding as of June 30, 2021

Tax Years 2011-2020	$ 43,570.30

Tax Year 2021 $ 81,348.29

13. **Department Report** – Written Reports Submitted

by: Police / Municipal Court / Neighborhood Watch – Sean Clayton, Chief of Police
Fire –Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman
Public Works Department – Oscar Crosby, Public Works Manager

Town Administrator Milie asked if anyone had any questions on the department reports. Council Member Henry asked about the Museum's water usage. Public Works Manager explained their water use is up because Public Works used their connection when working on well #3.

14. **Legal Report – Town Attorney**
    a) Second Reading of the Open Burning Notice Ordinance

Town Attorney Barrow explained this ordinance is at the request of the Fire Chief. Chief Bateman stated this is required because there have been changes to the State Law. **Council Member Williams made the motion to approve the new open burning ordinance with a second by Council Member Crenshaw.** Council Member Henry asked about a specific case concerning open burning. It was explained if it is bricks, barrels and pits, it is allowed. Council Member Henry asked for clarification of paragraph 4. Town Attorney Barrow stated the wording is confusing. **Council Member Williams amend motion to accept burn ordinance with exception to any clarifying changes to paragraph 4 exceptions to the article. Council Member Ward seconded the revised motion. The motion passed unanimously.**

    b) Short-term Rental Legal Update

Town Attorney Barrow stated he was to look in to HB 317 for clarification whether or not AirBB for example would collect the tax and send it to local government. It appears they State will be forwarding the funding to the local government. Council Member Crenshaw asked if it was fee. Town Attorney Barrow pointed out it has to be only what it cost to implement the ordinance. Town Administrator Milie stated if the host sites are the ones doing collecting that will be an expense towards the fee. Town Attorney Barrow stated he could not find case law on limiting STRs. Town Administrator Milie stated if there is no limit the Census will be affected by unlimited STRs.

15. **Mayor and Council –**

Mayor Goette announce those interested in running for Mayor and Council qualifying begins August 16 and goes to August 20th. See Town Clerk, Deatre Denion for further information. Town Hall will be closed on September 6th for Labor Day.

    a) **Water & Sewer Committee – Council Member Drohan**

Mayor Goette asked if Council Member Drohan had anything on the Water & Sewer Committee. He did not so Mayor Goette asked for a motion to go into Executive Session. **Council Member Drohan made the motion with a second from Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

16. **Executive Session-** Mayor requests a motion and a second to recess into executive session for the purpose of Legal and/or Personnel matters.

Mayor Goette asked for a motion to move into regular session. **Council Williams made the motion with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

The Mayor Goette asked for a motion to adjourn the meeting. Council Member Crenshaw made the motion with a second by Council Member Ward. The motion passed unanimously.

17. **Adjournment:**

The meeting adjourned at 8:49 pm.

Beth E. Goette

Mayor, Beth E. Goette

Clerk of Council, Deatre N. Denion